GG EZ: Game Concept Brief

Checkpoint Game Jam 2026 (UNOCT and UNICRI with Global Game Jam), theme Play to Prevent. Team: Carl Kho (Philippines, based in San Francisco) and Dain Kim. Entered 2026-10-31; this brief describes the build of 2026-11-01. Playable build and source: https://github.com/CarlKho-Minerva/gg-ez. The game runs in the browser, needs no account, and sends nothing to a server.

Page one is safe to read before playing. The last section is not.

1. The pitch

You lose an online fighting match by a hair. The stranger who beat you, lia_ph, types “ez”. A chat box opens with two replies, “okay that was clean” and “fuck off”, and a three-second clock. Letting the clock run out is the third answer. Then there is one more game.

GG EZ is a short browser game about the first rung of online hostility: the fast insult at whoever is nearest when something goes wrong. The connection is rigged against you. Inputs arrive late, a swing passes through empty air, and she survives with almost nothing left. The cruel reply is designed to be the easy one. You are the wolf. She is the wizard. A full run takes ten to fifteen minutes.

2. How to play

Keyboard on a computer. On a phone the same buttons appear on screen.

- Move: A and D, or the left and right arrows.
- Jump: W or the up arrow.
- Dash: S or the down arrow. A short dash forward, through her. You cannot be hit during its first moments.
- Strike: J. Three strikes in a row make a three-hit string. The third hit launches her.
- Cast: K throws a crescent across the arena. After two strikes, K becomes a finisher that hits for double.
- Block: hold L. A block in the instant before a hit lands is a parry. A parry staggers her.
- Dialogue: Space or Enter advances a line. Every line is subtitled.
- Reply: click one of the two buttons before the clock runs out, or say nothing.

Lia fights back. She closes distance, backs off, blinks across the arena, swings her staff up close and casts from range. In later rounds she fires barrages of three spells.

The sound toggle mutes everything. Progress saves at chapter boundaries when the browser allows it, and Continue resumes from the last one.

3. Team, credits and AI use

Carl Kho: design, code, writing. Dain Kim: pixel art and design. All art in the build is Dain’s.

AI use. Claude (Anthropic) wrote most of the code and the dialogue drafts from Carl and Dain’s design sessions and the storyboard; the team edited them. Sound effects, the voice lines and the arcade music loop were generated with ElevenLabs. Lia’s lines are synthetic speech from Microsoft’s Filipino neural voice (fil-PH-BlessicaNeural, Edge TTS); no real person’s voice was cloned. Krea 2 Turbo generated art only for the archived Godot prototype of October 2026; none of that art is in this build. The engine is Phaser 3.

Nothing the player picks leaves the browser. No UN names or emblems appear in the game.

4. For judges: the rest of the game (spoilers)

Stop here if you plan to play first.

What happens after the third loss

After the third loss by a hair, the controller leaves your hand and cracks the monitor. You fall through it into a room in Lapu-Lapu City at 2:07 AM. lia_ph is Lia, a customer-care agent on a remote night shift, playing during her break. You are a ghost. You can drift around the room and nothing in it can see you. You find her badge, her phone and her dinner, and read what you can. Any two of the three open the way out; the third stays there.

The connection pulls you back for another rigged match and the same two buttons. Then the room again, same camera, and the headset goes on. She takes a refund call from an angry customer. She keeps to her script; he does not. She answers her mother about sending money after payday. She trades messages with her friend Mika, who wants one more game. The shift passes in time stamps while you float in the room.

Then one more match, on a fair connection. Her skill is real; you can win or lose. The same chat opens with the same two buttons and the same three seconds. Nothing on screen marks either one. The epilogue returns to her shift at 4:25 AM, “Good morning”, and the credits.

The thirteen chapters

1. Matchmaking. The title screen finds lia_ph, region PH, high ping.
2. The first match. Lost by a hair. “ez”. Two replies, three seconds.
3. The rematch. Lost the same way. The same two replies.
4. The connection. The controller flies, the monitor cracks, and you are pulled through.
5. The wrong room. Lapu-Lapu City, 2:07 AM. Badge, phone and dinner.
6. The second match. Rigged again. The same two buttons, now knowing who is on the other side.
7. The return. The same room, the same framing. The headset goes on.
8. The call. A refund call from an angry customer.
9. Mama. Her mother asks about money. She answers after payday.
10. Mika. Her friend wants one more game.
11. The longest night. The shift passes while you float.
12. A fair fight. A stable connection. Win or lose.
13. The last reply. The same chat, the same buttons. Then 4:25 AM and “Good morning”.

The first three matches are rigged by lag so that you lose by a hair. Only the final one is fair.

Why this is Play to Prevent

Nobody is radicalised in this game and nobody is recruited. It is about the first rung. The organisers’ PVE 101 webinar names harassment and toxicity as the leading sign that identity dynamics are hardening into us-versus-them. Typing “ez” back at a stranger is the smallest version of that: a person reduced to a line of text. The game does three things with it.

1. The player does the harmful thing first. The match is rigged so the loss feels unfair, and the reply window is three seconds. The cruel reply is designed to be the easy one.

2. Then the player has to go and look. The room is not a lecture. It is a badge, a phone, a dinner, a call and two chats, in Cebuano at home with English under it, read at the player's own pace. She is in the same economy as the player. She is not a threat.
3. Then the same choice again, with the same two buttons, pixel for pixel. The intervention is the second press. The game does not score it, does not reward the kind reply, and does not make her easier to beat after the room. Winning the fair match depends on the fight, not on what the player saw or chose.

Know	Think	Feel	Do
The person behind "ez" has a life, and "it was just a game" lands on someone	"I don't start it, I respond" becomes "my response was out of proportion"	Frustration, then recognition	Pause before typing; pick the other reply when you meet her again

Guards. Her line is always small ("ez", "gg ez"); she is never cruel. The player never investigates or confronts anyone. Nothing rewards "my side good, their side bad". No religion, no politics, no real groups.

Cultural relevance. Lapu-Lapu City at 2 AM. A remote night shift on a customer-care account, a badge, a cup of noodles, an electric fan, a phone with her mother and her friend on it. Cebuano at home with an English gloss under every line; scripted English on the call. The pisonet (a pay-per-minute internet cafe) and the trash talk across the room are Carl's own.

What we claim and what we do not. A game about trash talk does not prevent radicalisation. It lets a player practise one pause, in a setting they already know, and shows them their own before and after. One playthrough does not change a person, and the game does not say that it does.

After the jam. A review of the Cebuano lines by an independent speaker, and of the call English by someone who has worked a Philippine BPO floor. A playtest pass on the fight balance. If the project is selected for the two-month phase, a second opponent with a different life.